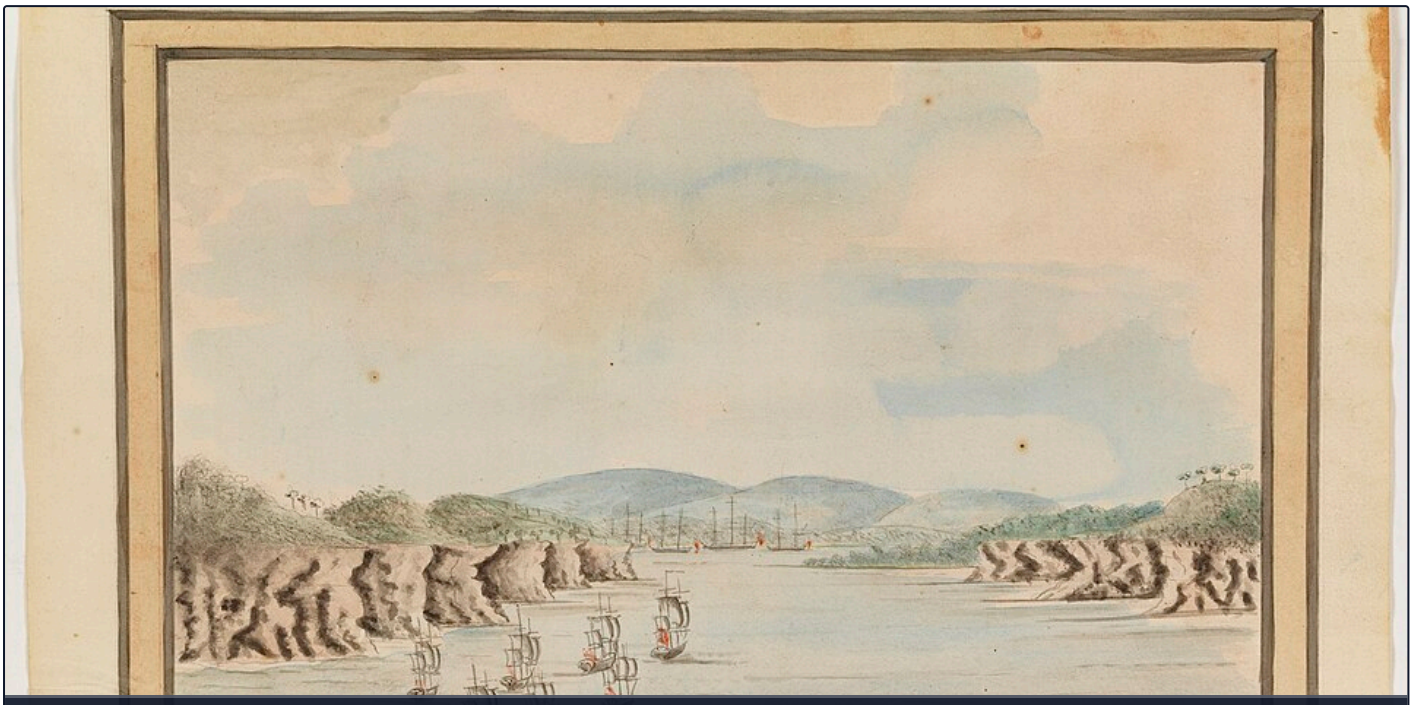
KEY STAGE 3 DISCIPLINARY HISTORY • THE BRITISH EMPIRE & WORLD HISTORY

1770 – 1901

THE HISTORY OF AUSTRALIA

First Nations, Colonisation, Frontier Resistance & The Path to Federation



ARCHIVAL PLATE: The First Fleet entering Botany Bay, January 1788 • Eleven British sailing vessels carrying roughly 1,400 convicts, marines, and civilian officials cast anchor off the eastern coast of Australia, initiating more than a century of imperial colonisation, territorial dispossession, and Indigenous resistance.

HISTORICAL OVERVIEW • 1770–1901

FIVE DISCIPLINARY ENQUIRIES

For more than sixty-five thousand years, hundreds of distinct First Nations cultivated complex societies, oral songlines, and sophisticated fire-stick land management systems across the Australian continent. In 1770, Lieutenant James Cook charted the eastern coastline aboard HMS Endeavour, formally claiming the land for King George III under the convenient imperial fiction of terra nullius—declaring an inhabited continent to be "nobody's land". Eighteen years later, Governor Arthur Phillip led the First Fleet into Sydney Cove to establish a brutal penal colony, banishing British convicts to the opposite side of the globe.

What colonial authorities envisaged as an orderly agricultural outpost rapidly ignited more than a century of fierce territorial conflict known as the Frontier Wars. From the devastating introduction of smallpox and Pemulwuy's Bidjigal guerrilla resistance to the martial-law clearance of Van Diemen's Land and the 1838 Myall Creek massacre, pastoral settlement wrought profound devastation upon First Nations peoples. Yet through the 1851 Gold Rush, the democratic rebellion of the Eureka Stockade, and the 1901 Federation, First Nations survivance endured to challenge the foundational legal myths of British colonisation.

THE CANONICAL ENQUIRIES • SCHEME OF LEARNING DIRECTORY **A3 SADDLE-STITCH FORMAT**

CORE CONCEPTS Songlines • Terra Nullius • Botany Bay • Penal Colony • Eora Resistance • Pemulwuy • Van Diemen's Land • Black War • Myall Creek • Ballarat Gold Rush • Eureka Stockade • White Australia Policy • Mabo Legacy

CHRONOLOGICAL MILESTONE HIGHWAY • 1770–1901

12 DECISIVE CAUSAL TURNING POINTS • ZERO MAPS MANDATE

1768–1770

Cook, Tupaia & The Myth of Terra Nullius

Ref [1.1–1.5]

Guided across Polynesia by high priest Tupaia, Captain Cook maps the eastern coastline on HMS Endeavour, claiming the territory for King George III under the legal fiction of terra nullius.

Jan 1788

Arrival of the First Fleet at Sydney Cove

Ref [2.1–2.3]

Governor Arthur Phillip lands 11 ships carrying roughly 750 convicts and marines at Sydney Cove, raising the Union Jack to found Britain's first Australian penal colony.

Apr 1789

The Sydney Basin Smallpox Catastrophe (Gal-galla)

Ref [3.1–3.2]

A devastating smallpox epidemic sweeps through the Sydney Basin, killing between 50% and 70% of the local Eora population and obliterating Indigenous clan leadership.

Nov 1789

Abduction of Woollarawarre Bennelong

Ref [3.2–3.3]

Phillip captures Bennelong to act as an imperial cultural mediator; though Bennelong visits London, the cross-cultural alliance collapses as settlement expands.

1797–1802

Pemulwuy's Resistance & The Battle of Parramatta

Ref [3.4–3.5]

Bidjigal resistance leader Pemulwuy leads 100 warriors in a direct daytime assault on colonial troops during a 12-year guerrilla war defending country until his death in 1802.

Mar 1804

Castle Hill Convict Rebellion (Vinegar Hill)

Ref [2.5, 4.1]

Over 200 predominantly Irish convicts stage an armed uprising outside Sydney demanding return to Ireland, but are swiftly routed by the New South Wales Corps at Rouse Hill.

1824–1828

Pastoral Expansion & Martial Law in Van Diemen's Land

Ref [4.1–4.3]

Merino sheep pastoralists seize fertile inland hunting grounds; mounting settler-Indigenous clashes prompt Governor George Arthur to declare martial law, unleashing the Black War.

Oct–Nov 1830

Governor Arthur's 'Black Line' Military Operation

Ref [4.2–4.3]

Over 2,200 soldiers, settlers, and convicts form an unbroken human cordon across Tasmania to drive surviving Aboriginal clans into the Tasman Peninsula, capturing only two people.

10 June 1838

The Myall Creek Massacre & Landmark Trials

Ref [4.4–4.5]

Eleven white stockmen brutally murder 28 unarmed Wirrayaraay women, children, and elders; seven perpetrators are convicted and hanged in an unprecedented colonial court trial.

May 1851

Australian Gold Rush Ignites at Ophir & Ballarat

Ref [5.1–5.2]

Edward Hargraves announces payable gold in NSW, followed by rich Victorian strikes that attract 600,000 global migrants and triple Australia's population within a decade.

3 Dec 1854

The Eureka Stockade Battle at Ballarat

Ref [5.2–5.3]

Gold miners rebel against corrupt police licence hunts under the Southern Cross flag; though crushed militarily in 20 minutes, the rebellion catalyzes universal male suffrage in Victoria.

1 Jan 1901

Australian Federation & The White Australia Policy

Ref [5.4–5.5]

The six self-governing colonies unite into the Commonwealth of Australia, immediately passing the Immigration Restriction Act to institutionalize racial exclusion and disenfranchise First Nations peoples.

MASTER DISCIPLINARY RETRIEVAL ENGINE

MASTER KNOWLEDGE RETRIEVAL QUIZ

Standard Recall Protocol: 25 core retrieval questions testing factual mastery across all five enquiries. Use for low-stakes weekly partner testing, silent memory flash-checks, or end-of-unit homework retrieval. (Answers verified in textbook narrative; zero answers printed.)

ENQUIRY 1: CLAIMING AUSTRALIA: COOK, TUPAIA & TERRA NULLIUS (1768–1770)

Page 3 • Ref [1.1]–[1.5]

1. What was the public scientific purpose of Captain Cook's 1768 Endeavour voyage to Tahiti?
2. What secret orders was Captain Cook given by the British Admiralty to execute after Tahiti?
3. Who was Tupaia, and how did his Polynesian navigation skills assist the Endeavour expedition?
4. Where did Captain Cook formally claim the eastern coast of Australia for King George III in August 1770?
5. What did the legal doctrine of terra nullius mean in British colonial law, and why was it applied?

ENQUIRY 2: THE FIRST FLEET & THE CONVICT PENAL COLONY (1783–1792)

Page 4 • Ref [2.1]–[2.5]

1. Why could Britain no longer transport convicted felons to North America after 1783?
2. What were the prison hulks moored along the River Thames and southern English naval ports?
3. On what exact date did Governor Arthur Phillip land at Sydney Cove and raise the Union Jack?
4. Why was the early penal settlement at Sydney Cove pushed to the brink of mass starvation in 1788–1790?
5. What was an 'emancipist' in colonial Australian society, and what rights did they possess?

ENQUIRY 3: FRONTIER WARFARE: SMALLPOX, BENNELONG & PEMULWUY (1788–1802)

Page 5 • Ref [3.1]–[3.5]

1. Approximately how long have First Nations peoples lived continuously across the Australian continent?
2. What was the catastrophic impact of the April 1789 smallpox epidemic (gal-galla) on the Sydney Eora?
3. Who was Woollarawarre Bennelong, and why did Governor Phillip capture and detain him in November 1789?
4. Which Bidjigal resistance warrior led a twelve-year guerrilla war against British expansion across Sydney?
5. What lethal proclamation did Governor King issue in November 1801 regarding Parramatta Indigenous clans?

ENQUIRY 4: THE FRONTIER WARS, PASTORAL EXPANSION & BLACK WAR (1803–1840)

Page 6 • Ref [4.1]–[4.5]

1. What was the island of Tasmania officially named during early British colonial rule until 1856?
2. What was Governor George Arthur's 'Black Line' military operation in Tasmania in October–November 1830?
3. Where were surviving Aboriginal Tasmanians exiled in the 1830s under George Augustus Robinson's scheme?
4. Why were wealthy pastoralists who seized vast inland Indigenous territories known as 'squatters'?
5. Why was the December 1838 Myall Creek massacre trial historically unprecedented in colonial Australia?

ENQUIRY 5: THE GOLD RUSH, EUREKA STOCKADE & FEDERATION (1851–1901)

Page 7 • Ref [5.1]–[5.5]

1. What was the immediate demographic and economic effect of the 1851 Australian Gold Rush?
2. What major financial and civil grievance sparked the 1854 Eureka Stockade rebellion in Ballarat?
3. What flag did the rebel miners swear allegiance to on Bakery Hill before the Eureka Stockade battle?
4. What was the White Australia Policy established by the 1901 Immigration Restriction Act?
5. What did the landmark 1992 Mabo Decision achieve in Australian High Court constitutional law?

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